Glossary

conventions (n) - a large formal meeting of people who have a similar interest

shatter (v) - to break suddenly into very small pieces

astray (adv.) - away from the correct path or correct way of doing something

mirth (n) - laughter, humour or happiness

comrade (n) - a friend

A. Based on your understanding of the poem, answer the questions in a sentence or two.

1. *The gladdest people living are the wholesome folks who make*
A circle at the fireside that no power but death can break.
   a. Who are the gladdest people living ?
   b. Where do they gather?
   c. What can break their unity?

2. *And the finest of conventions ever held beneath the sun*
Are the little family gatherings when the busy day is done.
   a. When do they have their family gatherings?
   b. Where do they have their family conventions?
   c. What does the poet mean by 'finest conventions'?

3. *There are rich folk, there are poor folk, who imagine they are wise,*
And they're very quick to shatter all the little family ties.
   a. What do the rich and poor folk imagine themselves to be?
   b. What do they do to their families?
   c . Whom does 'they' refer to?

4. *There are some who seem to fancy that for gladness they must roam,*
That for smiles that are the brightest they must wander far from home
   a. Why do they roam?
   b. According to them, when do they get bright smiles?

5. *But the gladdest sort of people, when the busy day is done,*
Are the brothers and the sisters who together share their fun.
   a. Who are the gladdest people?
   b. When do they share their fun?
   c. What does 'who' refer to?

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